

CoARA Action Plan

LAB University of Applied Sciences

Version 1.0

13.1.2025

1. INTRODUCTION AND PURPOSE OF THE ACTION PLAN

Objectives

The CoARA action plan outlines the steps LAB University of Applied Sciences will take to align its research and researcher evaluation practices with the commitments in the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA) agreement. Its purpose is to establish, strengthen, and reform evaluation practices to reflect responsible evaluation principles, emphasizing fairness, transparency, integrity, competence, and diversity. This plan is designed to create an equitable and supportive but pragmatic evaluation framework.

Context

LAB University of Applied Sciences signed the CoARA agreement at the end of 2023, proving a strategic commitment to advancing responsible research assessment. The action plan builds on LAB's strategic goals, 2024 interim strategy review and the operational changes implemented in 2024. These foundational elements provide a base for embedding CoARA commitments into daily activities, ensuring compliance with the agreement while establishing a professional research culture that balances organizational priorities with responsible evaluation principles.

Scope of the plan

The action plan spans a five-year period (2025–2029), providing a structured framework for implementing and refining research evaluation practices. The timeline includes key milestones for reforms, integrating CoARA principles into institutional operations, assessing annual progress and overall impact by the end of year. The remaining two years, 2028-2029, will be planned based on overall impact assessment.

Key focus of the action plan:

- *Promoting researcher mobility:* Enhancing opportunities for outgoing and incoming collaborations.
- *Establishing career pathways:* Recognizing diverse researcher profiles and contributions.
- *Establishing regional impact metrics:* Capturing the societal relevance of research activities.
- *Strengthening collaboration in networks:* Building interdisciplinary and inter-organizational partnerships.
- *Enhancing doctoral training programs:* Supporting early-career researchers with structured development.

- *Responsible researchers and research evaluation:* Developing processes, instructions and evaluation measures for responsible researcher and research evaluation.

The CoARA process in LAB University of Applied Sciences

The CoARA process in LAB follows a structured timeline to ensure the development and implementation of the CoARA Action Plan:

- **Current State Analysis (January-April 2024):** A comprehensive analysis of the current research assessment practices at LAB, identifying gaps and areas for improvement.
- **Benchmark and knowledge sharing between universities in Finland (March-May 2024):** Collaborative benchmarking with other universities in Finland to share knowledge and best practices in research assessment.
- **Plan preparation (August 2024):** Initial preparation of the CoARA Action Plan, outlining the necessary steps and actions to align with CoARA commitments.
- **Plan review by the expertise groups in LAB (September 2024):** A review of the draft action plan by internal expertise groups to refine and adjust the proposed actions.
- **Plan review by the management group of LAB and formal acceptance of CoARA Action Plan (October 2024):** The Management Board reviews the action plan and formally accepts it, ensuring alignment with LAB's strategic goals.
- **Plan Preparation (Final Version, November-December 2024):** Final revisions and preparation of the CoARA Action Plan, ready for full implementation in 2025.

2. COARA APPROACH IN LAB

Strategy and change approach

The CoARA reform at LAB University of Applied Sciences is aligned with its strategic priorities, such as sustainability, innovation, and fostering a circular economy. These priorities emphasize regenerative growth, interdisciplinary collaboration, and creating intangible value, which guide the integration of CoARA commitments.

The action plan integrates CoARA principles into everyday practices, focusing on improving research practices and adopting qualitative evaluation methods that emphasize both the quality and societal impact of research. Implementation is phased over five years, with regular feedback guiding adjustments. This structured approach ensures the sustainable adoption of CoARA principles while supporting LAB's commitment to innovation and fostering a fair and professional research environment.

Involvement of LAB community

Active involvement of the institutional community is central to the CoARA action plan. Researchers participate in initiatives such as mobility programs, career pathway development, and development of responsible researcher evaluation. These efforts support researchers at all career stages, fostering an inclusive and collaborative approach to professional growth.

Engagement methods include pilot projects for international mobility, workshops, and consultations to refine career pathways and feedback systems. Regular progress updates, knowledge-sharing sessions, and peer learning opportunities ensure transparency and promote good practices within and beyond LAB. Feedback from the institutional community is collected continuously to refine reform implementation and ensuring alignment with CoARA principles.

LAB's collaborative approach integrates CoARA principles into institutional culture, not just policies. By engaging the research community and fostering open communication, LAB aims to build cultural change that supports long-term institutional development.

3. CURRENT STATE

LAB University of Applied Sciences (LAB) is a relatively new institution, established in 2020 through the merger of Lahti University of Applied Sciences and Saimaa University of Applied Sciences. This recent formation presents both opportunities and challenges in aligning with the Coalition for Advancing Research Assessment (CoARA) commitments.

Strategic fit and current metrics

LAB's strategy emphasizes innovation, business, and industry, with a strong focus on sustainability and the circular economy. The institution aims to serve global business through practice-oriented higher education and research, development, and innovation (RDI) activities. This strategic direction aligns with CoARA's emphasis on responsible research assessment and the promotion of diverse research contributions.

As a relatively new organization with a young research tradition, LAB is in the process of establishing its research culture and assessment practices. This stage of development provides a unique opportunity to integrate CoARA commitments from the outset, fostering a culture that values qualitative evaluation and diverse research outputs.

Traditionally, the national level metrics have emphasized financial indicators, such as the monetary value of projects, rather than the broader impact of research. This focus may overlook significant contributions that do not directly translate into immediate financial gains but are valuable in terms of societal impact and knowledge advancement, especially on the researcher level. This perspective is acknowledged when the action plan was created.

Diverse research activities

The institution's researchers possess varying levels of formal education, reflecting LAB's applied research focus. This diversity necessitates assessment practices that recognize and value different types of expertise and contributions, moving beyond traditional academic metrics. LAB's research activities are multifaceted, encompassing various roles and expectations. This complexity requires flexible assessment frameworks that can accommodate a wide range of research outputs and impacts, ensuring that all contributions are fairly evaluated.

As a university of applied sciences in Finland, LAB emphasizes practical, industry-oriented research. Aligning with CoARA commitments involves ensuring that assessment practices appropriately value applied research outcomes, such as innovations, prototypes, and industry collaborations, alongside traditional academic publications.

4. FILLING THE GAP BETWEEN CURRENT STATE AND COARA CORE COMMITMENTS

Based on the current state analysis and the commitments outlined in the CoARA Agreement, specific change needs have been identified. These needs have been organized into three distinct action types: establish, reform, and review. This categorization enables a structured approach to aligning with CoARA principles while addressing both existing gaps and areas requiring enhancement (Table 1).

Establish: This category focuses on initiating new structures, processes, or frameworks that do not currently exist but are crucial for meeting CoARA commitments. Establishing these foundations is essential for addressing identified gaps in research assessment practices.

Reform: The reform category addresses existing practices and processes that require significant modifications to align with CoARA commitments. This involves transitioning from outdated or inappropriate assessment methods to innovative approaches centered on quality, fairness, and inclusivity.

Review: Review actions focus on systematically assessing and iterating upon existing criteria, tools, and processes. This category ensures that research assessment remains relevant, effective, and aligned with the evolving needs of researchers and the research community.

Based on the current state analysis and the requirements set by the CoARA commitments, it was identified that many of the CoARA requirements necessitate *Establish* activities. This is due to the partial absence of existing tools, processes, and professional roles required to meet these commitments. The most significant reason for this gap is that the institutional system and working culture at LAB are primarily rooted in education and regional development work, which traditionally prioritize different operational focuses.

It was also recognized that the CoARA action plan should not be perceived as irrelevant or an additional layer to daily activities. To ensure engagement, it was deemed critical that employees and management at all organizational levels understand the importance and relevance of CoARA-based activities. These activities should be framed as development initiatives the organization would need to undertake regardless, aligning with its broader goals. This approach, referred to in the LAB community as the "Embedded approach," ensures that changes are integrated into daily activities and result in actual, meaningful transformations within regular work processes.

Despite the practical nature of the development actions, it is essential that all *Establish*, *Reform*, and *Review* activities are evaluated rigorously. This evaluation is conducted in alignment with CoARA principles, focusing on the progress achieved compared to the baseline set in the current state analysis (2024). Furthermore, the alignment of these actions with LAB's strategic goals ensures that the initiatives contribute to the institution's broader mission and vision. This dual focus on CoARA compliance and strategic fit guarantees that the development actions not only address immediate gaps but also support long-term institutional growth and relevance.

Table 1. Identified change need based on analysis of current state and CoARA commitments

CoARA commitment	Identified change need
Recognize diverse contributions and career paths in research according to the needs and nature of the research.	Establish frameworks for evaluating diverse contributions and career paths, including qualitative measures for assessing non-traditional outputs and interdisciplinary work.
Base research assessment primarily on qualitative evaluation, with peer review as central, supported by the responsible use of quantitative indicators.	Review and reform current assessment practices by focusing on qualitative peer review, supported by carefully selected, ethically aligned quantitative indicators.
Abandon inappropriate uses of journal- and publication-based metrics (e.g., Journal Impact Factor and h-index).	Review journal- and publication-based metrics and reform them with alternative methods that evaluate research quality and impact qualitatively and contextually.
Avoid the use of rankings of research organisations in research assessment.	Reform comparative rankings towards collaborative benchmarks and mutual learning platforms that evaluate contributions without hierarchical structures.
Commit resources to reforming research assessment to achieve organizational changes.	Establish funding and human resources to creation and sustaining new research assessment processes, ensuring that these are embedded into the organizational structure.
Review and develop research assessment criteria, tools, and processes.	Establish systematic reviews of current criteria and tools and invest in developing new ones that address the specific contexts and needs of different research areas.
Raise awareness of research assessment reform and provide transparent communication, guidance, and training.	Establish training programs for staff and researchers to foster understanding of new assessment principles and ensure transparent communication of changes.

CoARA commitment	Identified change need
Exchange practices and experiences to promote mutual learning within and beyond the coalition.	Establish and reform partnerships and platforms for sharing practices and experiences with other organizations to encourage learning and refinement of assessment methods.
Communicate progress in implementing principles and commitments.	Establish a system for regular reporting on progress and outcomes, with mechanisms to share updates publicly and receive external feedback.
Evaluate practices, criteria, and tools based on solid research and make the findings openly available.	Establish robust mechanisms for self-evaluation and peer assessment, ensuring results and learnings are documented and made accessible for continuous improvement.

5. RESOURCE ALLOCATION

Capacity

To ensure the successful implementation of the CoARA action plan and other development activities, LAB will allocate the necessary resources, including staff time, infrastructure, and professional support. This capacity will be addressed both in the development phase and in the practical application of the reform. Staff time and expertise will be dedicated not only to planning and developing the necessary actions but also to ensuring that staff at all levels are equipped to understand and implement the changes.

Training and professional development programs will be provided to enable staff to effectively adapt to new practices and incorporate them into their daily work. This will include both individual-level support, ensuring that researchers can directly apply new assessment practices, and organizational-level support, where broader systems and processes are put in place to sustain the reforms over time.

Budget

LAB will define clear financial commitments to support the initiatives outlined in the CoARA action plan. This will include the allocation of funds for both short-term and long-term activities, ensuring that there is sufficient financial backing for training, system updates, and

necessary infrastructure. Resources will be allocated strategically to ensure that both the development and implementation phases are adequately supported.

Budgeting will follow the annual planning and decision-making cycle.

Support structures

To oversee the implementation of the CoARA action plan, LAB will utilize existing cross-faculty structures that are responsible for guiding and monitoring progress. These structures will ensure that the reform is successfully integrated into the daily operations of the institution, providing ongoing support and feedback mechanisms. They will be instrumental in addressing challenges, adjusting actions as necessary, and fostering collaboration across all levels of the organization, ensuring that the changes are effectively implemented and sustained.

6. ACTION PLAN

The actions outlined in this plan are designed to seamlessly integrate CoARA commitments into LAB's operational and strategic frameworks. They reflect a pragmatic approach by addressing specific needs with tailored solutions, ensuring alignment with institutional priorities while remaining manageable within existing resources. Each action emphasizes practicality and adaptability, promoting tangible outcomes that enhance research quality and societal impact without imposing undue administrative burdens. This focus enables LAB to foster a research environment that is both innovative and inclusive, supporting sustainable progress over time.

Theme 1: Researcher mobility (Outgoing)

Objective: Enhancing outgoing researcher mobility to strengthen international networks and foster knowledge exchange.

Actions: Creating a model and processes for research mobility. Developing partnerships and promoting peer learning activities that emphasize quality improvements.

Results: A formalized research mobility model, increased participation in international collaborations, and improved documentation of the impact of mobility on research quality and knowledge sharing.

Level: Organizational and individual.

Connection to the CoARA agreement: Networks, peer learning, investment in quality, qualitative evaluation of impact.

Schedule: Planning Q1-Q2/2025, pilots Q3-Q4 2025, review Q1/2026, full-scale launch Q2/2026.

Responsibility: Vice Rector for RDI in conjunction with Faculty directors, HR director and financial director.

Evaluation schemes: Progress review, pilot review, full-scale model review, biannual outcome review (when launched), impact evaluation 2027

Theme 2: Researcher mobility (Incoming)

Objective: Increase incoming researcher mobility to enhance institutional expertise and foster collaboration through visiting researchers.

Actions: Establish structured programs for hosting visiting researchers, including clear processes for short- and medium-term stays. Provide integration support, such as access to facilities, collaboration opportunities, and networking events with local research teams.

Results: A systematic framework for accommodating visiting researchers, improved collaboration between local and visiting scholars, and enhanced institutional expertise through diverse perspectives and knowledge exchange.

Level: Organizational and individual.

Connection to the CoARA agreement: Networks, peer learning, investment in quality, qualitative evaluation of impact.

Schedule: Planning Q2-Q3/2025, piloting Q4/2025-Q2/2026, full-scale launch Q3/2026.

Responsibility: Vice Rector for RDI in conjunction with Faculty directors, HR director and financial director.

Evaluation schemes: Progress review, pilot review, full-scale model review biannual outcome review (when launched), impact evaluation 2027

Theme 3: Career paths in research, development and innovation activities

Objective: Support flexible and transparent career paths in research, development, and innovation activities.

Actions: Create career path frameworks that recognize diverse researcher roles and contributions, including interdisciplinary and non-traditional outputs. Develop tailored professional development programs, mentorship opportunities, and evaluation tools that reflect qualitative growth metrics.

Results: Established frameworks for diverse career paths, improved career planning tools for researchers, and increased career satisfaction through tailored professional growth

opportunities. Clearer alignment between career progression and institutional goals.

Level: Organizational, group, and individual.

Connection to the CoARA agreement: Career paths, peer learning, investment in quality, qualitative evaluation of impact.

Schedule: planning Q1-Q2/2025, launch Q3/2025.

Responsibility: Vice Rector for RDI in conjunction with Faculty directors, HR director and financial director.

Evaluation schemes: Progress review, biannual outcome review (when launched), impact evaluation 2027.

Theme 4: Impact metrics for regional activities (direct or indirect research output)

Objective: Develop reliable metrics to assess the regional impact of direct and indirect research activities.

Actions: Collaborate with regional stakeholders to design and implement qualitative measurement tools. Incorporate metrics that evaluate societal relevance, innovation uptake, and long-term contributions to regional priorities. Establish feedback mechanisms for continuous improvement of these tools.

Results: Comprehensive metrics for capturing regional research impact, strengthened partnerships with stakeholders, and demonstrable alignment of research activities with societal priorities.

Level: Organizational and group.

Connection to the CoARA agreement: Regional impact, networks, qualitative measurement, peer learning, societal relevance.

Schedule: planning Q2-Q4/2025, operationalization Q1/2026.

Responsibility (person/entity): Vice Rector for RDI.

Evaluation schemes: Progress review, biannual outcome review (when impact measures are applied), impact evaluation 2027.

Theme 5: Researcher, research group and institutional collaboration in networks

Objective: Strengthen research collaboration through robust and interdisciplinary networks.

Actions: Facilitate the creation of interdisciplinary research projects by providing tools, platforms, and funding opportunities. Develop and share best practices for network collaboration, including guidelines for communication, joint project management, and co-authorship. Encourage participation in national and international research consortia and organize regular events to foster peer learning and knowledge exchange.

Results: Expanded and strengthened networks that drive high-quality research and innovation. Increased collaboration across disciplines and institutions, leading to measurable research outputs and enhanced capacity for securing competitive funding.

Level: Organizational and group.

Connection to the CoARA agreement: Networks, interdisciplinary collaboration, peer learning, investment in quality, qualitative evaluation of impact.

Schedule: Immediate reform and implantation Q1/2025.

Responsibility (person/entity): Vice Rector for RDI, Faculty Directors.

Evaluation schemes: Biannual outcome review, impact evaluation 2027.

Theme 6: Doctoral training

Objective: Support the re-formalization of doctoral training programs to ensure high-quality LAB strategy focused training that meets diverse academic and professional demands.

Actions: Develop structured processes for collaborating with partner institutions offering doctoral education. Implement qualitative evaluation methods to assess the effectiveness of training and career support. Facilitate career development initiatives tailored to doctoral researchers, including mentoring and access to professional networks.

Results: More formalized and structured doctoral training processes, enhanced collaboration with partner institutions, and improved preparation of doctoral researchers for diverse career opportunities.

Level: Group and individual.

Connection to the CoARA agreement: Doctoral training, career development, qualitative evaluation, investment in quality.

Schedule: Review in 2025, reform in late 2025/early 2026, ongoing process.

Responsibility (person/entity): Vice Rector for RDI, Faculty Directors

Evaluation schemes: Biannual outcome review, impact evaluation 2027.

Theme 7: Responsible evaluation of researchers and research

Objective: Adopt responsible and transparent practices for evaluating researchers and research activities.

Actions: Create a formal LAB policy for responsible researcher and research evaluation, encompassing recruiting, career paths, mobility, networks, and capability-building. Use peer learning (researcher to researcher, research group to research group) to refine evaluation criteria and ensure alignment with CoARA's principles. Regularly review and update evaluation frameworks to prioritize qualitative and contextual evaluation criteria.

Results: A formalized policy for responsible evaluation, standardized evaluation frameworks, improved transparency, and enhanced research quality through ethical and inclusive practices.

Level: Organizational, group, and individual.

Connection to the CoARA agreement: Responsible evaluation, formal policy, mobility, networks, career paths, qualitative criteria, investment in quality.

Schedule: planning Q2-Q3/2025, launch Q4/2025

Responsibility (person/entity): Vice rector for RDI

Evaluation schemes: Progress review, biannual outcome review (when impact measures are applied), impact evaluation 2027.

7. KNOWLEDGE SHARING AND LEARNING PROCESSES IN NETWORKS

As a result of the implementation of the CoARA action plan, along with the outcomes of numerous other development activities, knowledge sharing, community engagement, and mutual learning will be operationalized as follows:

Knowledge sharing

To enhance knowledge sharing, LAB will participate in national level mechanisms for exchanging best practices and insights with other CoARA members and external partners. especially in the field of Universities of Applied Sciences events such as webinars, workshops, and collaborative platforms will be utilized, where research assessment practices, tools, and strategies can be shared.

These channels will also serve as a space to discuss challenges and explore innovative solutions in research evaluation. Additionally, a knowledge repository will be created to store and share successful case studies and research outcomes, ensuring that these resources are easily accessible to all stakeholders.

LAB community engagement

To ensure that CoARA principles are fully integrated into LAB's research culture, the university will promote a culture of community engagement within the institution. This will involve promoting internal dialogue on research assessment, where faculty, support staff, and leadership can discuss the goals, principles, and implementation of CoARA commitments.

LAB will encourage active participation from all levels of the organization, ensuring that the development and adoption of new research assessment practices are understood and supported across the board. Regular forums, workshops, and meetings will be organized to keep all stakeholders informed, engaged, and involved in the process of aligning LAB's practices with CoARA principles.

Mutual learning (partners)

LAB will prioritize mutual learning by actively incorporating feedback and examples from its project partners and research collaborators into its research assessment practices. Cross-institutional meetings and collaborative research initiatives will be organized to facilitate the exchange of experiences and best practices in relation to CoARA principles. These interactions will allow LAB to learn from the successes and challenges faced by its partners, ensuring that LAB's approach remains adaptive, relevant, and effective.

A feedback loop will be created where insights from partner institutions and research projects will be systematically integrated into LAB's development process. Peer learning will be promoted through joint research initiatives, co-created projects, and mentorship programs, all of which will help refine LAB's research assessment framework and strengthen its overall practices.

8. MONITORING AND EVALUATION

The monitoring and evaluation of the action plan will be conducted to ensure alignment with objectives and to provide opportunities for continuous improvement.

Progress monitoring

Indicators to track progress have been defined for each main task in the action plan. These indicators focus on the development actions and are distinct from outcome and impact measures. Evaluation cycles will follow biannual schedule, with progress measured and reviewed regularly. Existing management structures will oversee the process to avoid duplication of effort. After the development period in 2025, the focus will shift toward evaluating outcomes and impacts, ensuring the long-term effectiveness of the initiatives.

Stakeholder involvement

Stakeholders will be involved once per evaluation cycle year. This engagement will ensure that diverse perspectives are included in the review of practices and progress. Feedback will be collected through structured processes, such as annual stakeholder meetings,

surveys, or focus groups. The insights gained will guide necessary adjustments and refinements to the action plan.

Adaptation

Adaptation of approaches will occur twice a year. Adjustments for the autumn season will be made in June, while those for the spring season will be made in December. These refinements will be based on the outcomes of the biannual evaluations and feedback from stakeholders. Proposed changes will be reviewed and implemented in consultation with relevant management structures to ensure timely and effective action.

Management and reporting responsibilities

The RDI management group will be responsible for operationalizing the evaluation cycle. Support from subgroups will be utilized as needed to ensure comprehensive oversight. Each faculty will monitor and evaluate progress from an operational and tactical perspective through existing management team structures. Both the RDI management group and faculty management teams will report progress to the RDI Vice Rector and the LAB Executive group.

Full-scale impact evaluation

A full-scale impact evaluation will be conducted in autumn 2027. This evaluation will assess not only progress but also the outcomes and impacts of the action plan. The findings will provide a comprehensive understanding of the plan's long-term success and areas for further development.

Documentation and risk mitigation

Progress and evaluation results will be documented using standardized templates to ensure consistency and comparability. Risks related to delays, reporting inaccuracies, or misaligned measures will be mitigated through regular reviews and capacity-building efforts within the teams and management structures involved. These processes will be aligned with CoARA principles, ensuring a transparent and qualitative approach to progress tracking.

Identified risks and risk management solutions***Risk 1: Ineffective progress monitoring***

Risk management: Progress indicators have been aligned with development actions through regular biannual reviews. Cross-functional teams have been established to verify that the monitoring process reflects actual progress accurately.

Risk 2: Misaligned indicators and objectives

Risk management: Biannual reviews of progress indicators have been scheduled to ensure alignment with action plan objectives. Stakeholders are involved in validating the relevance and accuracy of the indicators.

Risk 3: Non-coherent and inconsistent data collection across faculties

Risk management: Data collection templates and protocols have been standardized across faculties. Training sessions and regular audits have been introduced to ensure consistency and mitigate errors.

Risk 4: Limited engagement or interest from stakeholders

Risk management: Transparency has been increased by sharing progress reports and involving stakeholders in decision-making meetings. Participation has been incentivized by highlighting the benefits of their input on the action plan's success.

Risk 5: Resistance to adaptation

Risk management: The purpose and benefits of biannual adaptations have been communicated clearly. Case studies and examples of successful adjustments are used to encourage acceptance and buy-in from all levels.

9. COMMUNICATION PLAN

The communication plan ensures the dissemination of key information regarding the CoARA action plan's progress, achievements, and outcomes. This plan has been developed to maintain internal transparency, enhance external visibility, and foster engagement with stakeholders at all levels. The communication efforts are structured through an annual communication framework and a thematic approach.

Internal transparency in the LAB community

Starting from January 2025, internal communication prioritizes clarity and inclusivity by

ensuring all staff are kept informed about the action plan's progress and developments. Quarterly progress summaries are prepared and shared on the LAB intranet. More direct communication is targeted at research groups and subsequently cascaded to individual staff members. This approach strengthens engagement and fosters a sense of shared responsibility within the organization. To further support understanding, a Moodle-based test for the CoARA badge will be launched in autumn 2025, reinforcing staff awareness and commitment to the action plan.

The operationalization of the communication plan for 2026 will be planned in detail during autumn 2025.

External visibility

External communication is focused on reaching university and research organization partners under the CoARA label. Progress and outcomes of development actions are communicated through formal channels and established formats, ensuring consistency and professionalism. Updates are shared with external stakeholders, providing insights into achievements and fostering confidence in the plan's progress.

Engagement within the CoARA community is maintained through active sharing of experiences and lessons learned. These interactions occur on national and European levels, contributing to mutual learning and alignment with CoARA's broader objectives. This ongoing dialogue supports the action plan's alignment with international best practices.

Annual communication framework

An annual communication framework has been established to ensure systematic updates on the action plan's progress. This framework emphasizes key milestones, achievements, and the outcomes of development actions. By maintaining a consistent annual communication rhythm, stakeholders are provided with a clear view of the plan's trajectory and successes.

Focus: research groups, individuals, external stakeholders—mainly universities and research institutions.

Thematic communication plan

A thematic communication plan complements the annual framework by addressing specific topics and events. This includes organizing and promoting workshops, webinars, podcasts, and other forums focused on the CoARA action plan. These thematic initiatives aim to

provide deeper engagement opportunities, enabling stakeholders to better understand and contribute to the plan's objectives.

Focus: faculty management teams, research group leaders, support service representatives.